

LUDHIANA | Bad Business

Just when Ludhiana was basking in the glory of being tagged the best-for-business by the World Bank, two back-to-back unrelated protests in two days shook the city. The first one—a violent protest by migrants—was caused when the state police refused to entertain complaints of snatchings by a biker gang from a group of migrants. DGP P.S. Gill said the doors had been slammed on pleading migrants since the police were “busy” preparing for a public function, which was nothing but a display of his force’s callousness. The second was a clash between radical Sikhs and police who were trying to stop the former from storming the religious congregation of a Nurmahal-based Hindu



PROTESTERS IN
LUDHIANA

religious sect. Police intelligence had cautioned the Government about possible attacks, but it didn’t turn down an MLA of the ruling party’s coalition partner, the BJP, Anil Bedi, who was insistent on the event. While the Government showed that it was liberal enough in ‘granting religious liberty’, its security preparation was another story.

by Arvind Chhabra

JAIPUR |

Clean Bowled

It was his second defeat in nine months. Lalit Modi’s attempt to regain control of the Rajasthan Cricket Association failed yet again after the BCCI strongman lost the election for the president’s post to Union Minister C.P. Joshi. Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot also played an innings to help Joshi win. His own man Shiv Charan Mali was withdrawn to ensure smooth sailing for Joshi. Looks like IPL chief and marketing whiz Modi must learn some politics when he takes on politicians even in the crick-eting world.

by Rohit Parihar

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